Latin America data centers: 2025 stock and cross-checks

What this note does

No statistical agency in Latin America measures investment in data centers. What is measured, and measured well by commercial trackers, is capacity: the electrical power available to IT equipment in each facility, in megawatts. This note converts that capacity into a capital stock using a construction cost per megawatt, then checks the result against every official or industry figure available country by country, and against Spain, where SpainDC and Pb7 Research publish the equivalent exercise.

Four results stand out.

Latin America held 1,307 MW at the end of 2025, which at US$10m per MW is a capital stock of approximately US$13.1bn. Brazil accounts for 44% of it, Mexico for 24% and Chile for 20%.

Spain alone held 439 MW, a third of the regional figure, yet invested about as much during 2025 as the whole region did: €2.1bn against approximately US$2.3bn. Spain is simply growing faster, at 24% in 2025 and a projected 42% a year to 2030, against 16% a year for Latin American capacity since 2019.

Spain's published investment figures validate the cost benchmark from outside the region. SpainDC reports €25bn of construction for roughly 2,100 MW of new capacity, or about €12m per MW, close to the US$10m used here.

Announced investment is not capital formation. Latin America recorded US$45.6bn of announcements in communications in 2025, four fifths of it a single project in Brazil, against roughly US$2.3bn of capacity actually delivered.

What the numbers measure, and where they come from

The industry splits facilities in two, and the distinction matters for who books the investment. Colocation refers to buildings put up by specialist operators, who rent floor space and power to tenants; the largest of these, leased wholesale to cloud firms, are called scale colocation. Cloud providers' own facilities refers to facilities the cloud

providers build and own themselves, mostly Amazon Web Services, Microsoft and Google. The same firms also rent heavily from colocation operators, 731 MW of it in Latin America, so that capacity belongs to the colocation stock and is counted once.

Capacity is quoted as IT power in megawatts, the power available to the servers rather than the total drawn by the site. It is the industry's standard size measure because grid access, not land or capital, binds expansion.

The cost benchmark covers building and fitting out a facility: shell, electrical and mechanical systems, land, fees and financing. It excludes the servers and accelerators inside, which the tenant buys and generally imports. Investment figures that include that equipment run three times higher per megawatt, which is why headline announcements and construction capex cannot be compared directly.

Sources: JLL for Latin American capacity, SpainDC and Pb7 Research for Spain, Turner & Townsend for construction costs, national associations and governments for country cross-checks, and CEPAL for foreign investment announcements. Each is identified where it is used.

Regional stock, end-2025

Capacity from JLL's Latin America Data Center Report 2026, measured at year-end 2025, valued at US$10m per MW. The method note at the end sets out where that price comes from.

	MW	Implied capex
Rented capacity (colocation)	1,105	US$11.1bn
Hyperscale owner-occupied	202	US$2.0bn
Total stock	**1,307**	**US$13.1bn**

The flows behind that stock: 232 MW came into service during 2025, worth US$2.3bn; 683 MW is under construction, worth US$6.8bn and completing in 2026 and 2027; and operators have announced a further 3,889 MW, which would be US$39bn if all of it were built. The last figure needs a large discount, since tenants have committed to only 26% of the capacity already under construction.

By country

Country	Colocation MW	Hyperscale MW	Total MW	Implied capex
Brazil	520	59	579	US$5.8bn
Mexico	268	50	318	US$3.2bn
Chile	171	93	264	US$2.6bn
Colombia	47	—	47	US$0.5bn
Argentina	45	—	45	US$0.5bn
Peru	27	—	27	US$0.3bn
Others (Uruguay, Panama, Costa Rica, Curaçao)	15	—	15	US$0.2bn

Country totals aggregate JLL's city-level map; the cloud providers' own capacity is split using JLL's shares (Santiago 46%, Campinas 29%, Querétaro 25%). The 731 MW leased by hyperscalers from colocation providers sits inside the colocation inventory and is not counted twice. About 12 MW is unallocated by rounding.

Spain as a benchmark

Spain is the natural comparison. SpainDC and Pb7 Research publish an annual report built the same way, capacity plus construction investment, so the two sets of numbers can be read side by side. Spain is also a useful mirror for policy: a mid-sized European economy that was peripheral in this industry five years ago and is now a secondary hub, constrained by grid access rather than by capital.

	Spain	Latin America
Installed IT power, end-2025	439 MW	1,307 MW
Growth in 2025	+24%	+20% (rented capacity)
Investment during 2025	€2.1bn	approximately US$2.3bn
Capacity projected for 2030	2,537 MW, six times 2025	no comparable official projection

	Spain	Latin America
Construction investment, 2026–30	€25bn	no published figure
Including equipment and services, 2025–30	€66.9bn	no published figure

Spain holds a third of Latin America's capacity and invested about as much during 2025, because it is growing far faster. Its 2025 spending divides into €1,099m by rental operators and €977m by the cloud providers themselves, the latter nearly triple the €344m of 2024. SpainDC expects annual construction spending to pass €4bn before 2030, against roughly US$2.3bn a year for all of Latin America today.

The Spanish figures also discipline the cost assumption used here. Construction of €25bn for roughly 2,100 MW of new capacity works out at about €12m per MW, close to the US$10m applied to Latin America. Adding equipment, software and services takes the total to €66.9bn, or near €32m per MW. That is the same threshold above which Latin American headline figures stop being construction and start including imported IT equipment.

Two further Spanish numbers travel well. PwC counts 8.7 GW of grid connection requests for Spanish data centers, of which only one megawatt in four has been granted, which is a rare measured estimate of how much speculative pipelines overstate. And SpainDC puts the sector's contribution to GDP at €3.6bn in 2026, rising above €7bn a year by 2030, for a cumulative €31bn over 2025 to 2030. Nothing equivalent has been published for any Latin American country; the closest is the IDB's study of Colombia, which estimates GDP effects without estimating investment.

Country cross-checks

Brazil. The Brazilian association ABDC reports the country passed 1 GW of live capacity in the first quarter of 2026, citing datacenterHawk, against JLL's 579 MW at end-2025. The gap is too large for one quarter and probably reflects a wider definition that includes the in-house facilities of banks, telecoms operators and government, which JLL leaves out. ABDC's other figure supports the cost assumption, since approximately US$20bn for a +2,000 MW pipeline is exactly US$10m per MW. ABDC

Mexico. MexDC reports 235 MW operating in 2025 and 279 MW in 2026, up from 115.5 MW in 2024. JLL's 318 MW is higher because it counts the cloud providers' own facilities in Querétaro, which the association's figure appears to leave out. The two are consistent.

MexDC · CFE bulletin, Sep 2026

Chile. The Plan Nacional de Data Centers records 198 MW in 2023, up from 35 MW in 2013, against JLL's 264 MW at end-2025. MinCiencia separately reports US$2.3bn invested over the last five years, the only official realized-investment figure in the region. Against the roughly 230 MW added since 2020 that implies approximately US$10m per MW, which supports the benchmark. PDATA, PDF · investment guide

Colombia, Argentina, Peru. No official capacity or investment statistic. Colombia's most-quoted number, US$1.16bn by 2030, is Arizton market size, often misattributed to the IDB.

CEPAL FDI announcements

CEPAL is the only official statistical source carrying data center-relevant investment figures. Its numbers are announcements taken from Financial Times fDi Markets, and they do not compare with balance-of-payments flows or with realized capex. From La Inversión Extranjera Directa en América Latina y el Caribe 2026 (LC/PUB.2026/6-P, June 2026), executive summary and Chapter I, section B.4:

- LAC announcements in 2025 came to US$114.1bn across 1,326 projects, down 34.3% in value.
- Communications was the largest sector at 40% of the total, up 172% on 2024. That is approximately US$45.6bn, my calculation from the 40% share.
- One project accounts for 83% of the communications total: TikTok's data center in Ceará at US$37.7bn. Stripping it out leaves roughly US$8bn.
- Globally, 92% of the US$319bn in communications announcements were data processing and hosting.

The 2025 edition (data for 2024) reported record digital-technology FDI of US$20.253bn, up 36%, led by Mexico (US$9,251m) and Brazil (US$5,854m).

Announcements overstate activity by an order of magnitude. The region announced US$45.6bn against roughly US$2.3bn of capacity actually delivered in 2025, and the TikTok project alone is worth three times the installed capital stock. Its implied US$37m per MW also shows that headline announcements bundle in tenant IT equipment, which national accounts record as imported equipment rather than construction.

PDF · publication page

Method note: the US$10m per MW benchmark

Turner & Townsend's construction cost index puts LatAm at the low end of its global range: Bogotá at US$7.49/W against US$10.0 for Madrid and Dublin, US$13.3 for Silicon Valley and US$15.2 for Tokyo. That index covers construction alone and leaves out land, fees, financing and IT equipment. Adding the first three brings a build to approximately US$10m per MW, which matches both the Brazilian association's rule of thumb and Chile's official figure.

The benchmark excludes tenant IT. Published figures that divide out above roughly US$30m per MW, such as TikTok at 37 and MexDC's US$82.5bn plan at 57, embed servers and GPUs and do not compare with the stock here.

Two limits apply. JLL counts commercial facilities only, so the in-house data centers run by banks, telecoms operators and the public sector are missing and the stock is understated. And multiplying current capacity by current costs gives a replacement-cost stock, not a historical-cost accumulation.

Pipeline and projections

Capacity pipelines have usable sources. Dollar projections at country level mostly do not, so the credible route is MW times cost.

- **JLL, region-wide.** 683 MW under construction, only 26% preleased, and 3,889 MW of planned colocation. At US$10m per MW that is US$6.8bn already committed and US$39bn that depends on projects going ahead.
- **Brazil.** MME projects installed data center demand of 9,959 MW by 2030 and 13,321 MW by 2036. EPE has mapped 26.3 GW of grid connection requests to 2038 and is building an annual data center survey, which would be the region's first official statistic.
- **Mexico.** MexDC projects 1.73 GW of required capacity by 2031, a figure CFE has adopted for its own planning.
- **Chile.** The Plan Nacional de Data Centers expects capacity to triple within five years, with 30-plus projects worth US$4.2bn in development.

Grid-request pipelines overstate what gets built, and Spain puts a number on the gap. PwC for SpainDC counts 8.7 GW of connection requests, of which only one MW in four has been awarded. Brazilian regulators give the same warning about their 26.3 GW. Applying a comparable ratio to Brazil's requests lands near the MME's own 2030 demand projection, which checks both figures.